

willing to put aside your own indulgences to meet needs in other people's lives. Begin to pray about the material needs you have and let God provide them without borrowing, so that your children can see that God is real.

(2) *Exercise self-discipline.* There's no way that parents can establish financial discipline in their children if they themselves are undisciplined.

In a practical way, this may be as simple as sharing your budget with your children to show them how you save to buy clothes, repair your car, take vacations, et cetera. Too often our children are led to believe that money really does grow on trees and all we have to do is pick some off when we need it. To allow your children to live this fantasy is to invite disaster when they're adults.

Parents need to practice moderation, regardless of their ability to generate income. God's instructions require that we exercise discipline in everything we do. It's easy to rationalize indulgence and lavishness under the "live like the King's kid" philosophy. If you believe that, look at the examples in God's Word. First, observe the King and see if He ever lived lavishly. Second, look at the men that Christ poured His life into and see if they did. And third, look at the Apostle Paul's example. You don't have to live in poverty to serve Christ, but self-discipline and moderation are the rules.

(3) *Teach your children that everybody needs to live on a budget.* It doesn't matter whether you make \$8,000 a year or \$800,000 a year, you need a budget.

A budget for children is a plan for managing their money as they make it. The simplest budget for a child has four parts: giving, spending, savings, and surplus. The plan I recommend to start with is 10 percent for giving, 40 percent for spending, 25 percent for long-term savings (college, cars, and the like) and 25 percent for surplus (a standby reserve fund).

The spending budget can be further divided according to the age and needs of each child. Obviously, the spending needs of an 8-year-old will be vastly different than those of a 17-year-old.